

I'll use the same exhaustive family sweep as the fullest reference, but I'll keep **Romance** the language-family term and **Romanticism** clearly separated from ordinary romantic-love usage.

Word family: **romance** / **romances** / **romanced** / **romancing** / **romantic** / **romantically** / **romanticism** / **Romanticism** / **romanticize** / **romanticise** / **romanticization** / **romanticisation** / **romanticized** / **romanticised** / **unromantic** / **romancer**

Base word: **romance**

Plural: **romances**

Verb forms: **romances**, **romanced**, **romancing**

Major related forms:

* **romantic**

* **romantically**

* **romanticism**

* **Romanticism** — historical artistic/intellectual movement

* **romanticize** / **romanticise**

* **romanticization** / **romanticisation**

* **unromantic**

* **romancer** — uncommon/old-fashioned in several senses

Major compounds/constructions:

* **romance with someone**

* **have a romance**

* **love and romance**

* **romantic relationship**

* **romantic partner**

* **romantic attraction**

* **romantic interest**

* **romantic feelings**

* **office romance**

* **holiday romance**

* **summer romance**

* **whirlwind romance**

* **secret romance**

* **forbidden romance**

* **romance novel**

* **romance fiction**

* **historical romance**

* **paranormal romance**

* **romantic comedy**

* **romantic drama**

* **medieval romance**

* **chivalric romance**

- * romantic ideal
- * hopeless romantic
- * romanticize the past
- * romance scam / romance fraud
- * **Romance language**
- * **Romance languages**
- * **Romance linguistics / philology**

Your passage:

> “First, a café is a business before it is a **romance**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **romance** does **not** mean a love affair.

It means:

> **the attractive, idealized, emotionally appealing picture of café ownership—the beautiful fantasy of warm lighting, handmade menus, pastries, independence and lifestyle—before the less glamorous commercial realities are considered.**

繁體中文：

- * **浪漫想像**
- * **浪漫化的幻想**
- * **美好而理想化的一面**
- * **令人嚮往的情懷**

A very natural translation is:

> “a café is a business before it is a romance”

「咖啡店首先是一門生意，而不是一場浪漫幻想。」

The following sentence explains the meaning:

> people imagine lighting, menus and pastries, but forget rent, wages, waste, licences and slow business days.

So **romance** here contrasts with:

> **commercial reality**

rather than with “friendship.”

A. ROMANCE = LOVE / ROMANTIC RELATIONSHIP

1. **romance = a romantic or sexual love relationship (戀情 ; 愛情關係) **

> “A romance developed between them.”

「兩人之間發展出一段**戀情**。」

This is one of the main modern noun senses.

2. **have a romance with someone = 與某人談戀愛 / 有戀情**

> “She had a brief romance with a colleague.”

「她曾與一名同事有過一段短暫的**戀情**。」

3. **a romance between A and B**

> “The novel follows a romance between two childhood friends.”

「小說描寫兩名童年朋友之間的**戀情**。」

B. SHORT / LONG ROMANCES

4. **brief romance = 短暫戀情**

5. **long-running romance = 長期戀情**

Less fixed than **long-term relationship**, but normal.

6. **whirlwind romance = 發展極快、激情強烈的戀情**

> “They married after a whirlwind romance.”

「他們在一段**迅速而熱烈的戀情**後結婚。」

Core implication:

> relationship develops unusually quickly.

C. SEASONAL / TRAVEL ROMANCE

7. **summer romance = 夏日戀情**

Usually a romantic relationship associated with one summer and often temporary.

8. **holiday romance = 假日戀情 / 旅途戀情**

Especially BrE.

A relationship formed during a holiday/vacation.

9. **vacation romance**

AmE counterpart, though **holiday romance** is the more established fixed phrase internationally.

D. WORKPLACE ROMANCE

10. **office romance = 辦公室戀情**

A romantic relationship between people working in the same workplace.

11. **workplace romance = 職場戀情**

More formal/general than **office romance**.

E. SECRET / FORBIDDEN ROMANCE

12. **secret romance = 秘密戀情**

13. **forbidden romance = 禁忌 / 不被允許的戀情**

Often used in fiction where:

- * families;
- * social rules;
- * institutions;
- * conflicting loyalties

prevent the relationship.

F. ROMANCE = ROMANTIC LOVE AS A GENERAL IDEA

14. **romance = romantic love, courtship, and affectionate excitement generally (浪漫愛情 ; 戀愛情調)**

Not necessarily one particular relationship.

> “There isn't much romance in their marriage anymore.”

「他們的婚姻裏已經沒有多少**浪漫情調**了。」

15. **love and romance = 愛與浪漫**

> “The film is full of love and romance.”

「電影充滿**愛情和浪漫情懷**。」

G. KEEP THE ROMANCE ALIVE

16. **keep romance alive = 維持戀愛中的浪漫感**

> “They still try to keep the romance alive.”

「他們仍努力維持感情中的**浪漫感**。」

17. **put the romance back into a relationship**

= 重新找回關係中的浪漫情調.

H. **ROMANCE IS DEAD**

18. **romance is dead = 浪漫已死**

A humorous/cynical expression suggesting that:

> romantic gestures, courtship, or sentimental love no longer seem important.

Not literally about a particular relationship ending.

I. ROMANCE = GLAMOUR / EXCITEMENT / IDEALIZED APPEAL

This is the branch closest to your passage.

19. **romance = attractive, exciting, idealized quality associated with something (浪漫情懷 ; 令人嚮往的魅力) **

> “He was attracted by the romance of life at sea.”

「他被海上生活的**浪漫想像 / 迷人情懷**吸引。」

No love relationship is involved.

20. **the romance of X = X 所帶來的浪漫想像 / 魅力**

Examples:

- * the romance of travel
- * the romance of the open road
- * the romance of entrepreneurship
- * the romance of old trains
- * the romance of café culture

The speaker focuses on:

> emotional appeal, adventure, nostalgia, beauty, idealization.

21. **romance vs reality**

A major conceptual contrast.

> “The romance of running a café can hide the financial reality.”

「經營咖啡店的**浪漫想像**可能掩蓋財務現實。」

This is almost exactly the passage.

J. ROMANCE = IDEALIZED FANTASY

22. **romance = idealized or unrealistic conception of something (浪漫幻想) **

> “Forget the romance for a moment and look at the numbers.”

「暫時放下那些**浪漫幻想**，看看實際數字。」

This can be mildly critical.

It suggests:

> attractive imagination has displaced practical judgment.

K. “A BUSINESS BEFORE IT IS A ROMANCE”

The sentence:

> “a café is a business before it is a romance”

means:

business

rent, staff, cost, licensing, supply, sales, survival.

romance

beautiful atmosphere, personal dream, lifestyle image, emotional appeal.

The writer is not rejecting romance entirely.

The argument is:

> **economic reality must come first.**

L. ROMANCE = STORY ABOUT LOVE

23. **romance = story centered substantially on a romantic relationship (愛情故事) **

> “It's a romance set in nineteenth-century France.”

「這是一個以十九世紀法國為背景的**愛情故事**。」

Can refer to:

* novel;

* film;

* play;

* television story.

M. ROMANCE FICTION

24. **romance fiction = 愛情小說 / 愛情文學類型**

A literary/commercial genre centered primarily on the development of a romantic relationship.

25. **romance novel = 愛情小說**

> “She writes romance novels.”

「她創作**愛情小說**。」

26. **romance writer / romance author = 愛情小說作家**

27. **romance reader = 愛情小說讀者**

N. ROMANCE SUBGENRES

These are established publishing categories rather than new meanings of the word.

28. **contemporary romance = 當代愛情小說**

Set broadly in a contemporary period.

29. **historical romance = 歷史愛情小說**

A romantic narrative set in an earlier historical period.

30. **paranormal romance = 超自然愛情小說**

Combines romantic plot with supernatural elements.

31. **romantic suspense = 愛情懸疑**

Combines romance with:

- * danger;
- * mystery;
- * suspense.

32. **fantasy romance / romantic fantasy**

Related categories whose precise publishing use varies.

O. ROMANTIC COMEDY

33. **romantic comedy / rom-com = 愛情喜劇**

Story combining:

- * romance;
- * comedy.

Usually follows romantic relationship development as a central element.

P. ROMANTIC DRAMA

34. **romantic drama = 愛情劇 / 愛情戲劇**

A drama centered substantially on romantic relationships, usually with less comedic emphasis than a rom-com.

Q. MEDIEVAL ROMANCE

Now a major literary-historical branch.

35. **romance = medieval narrative of adventure, chivalry, love, marvels, heroic quests (中古騎士傳奇) **

This meaning predates the modern love-story sense.

Common features could include:

- * knights;
- * quests;
- * courtly love;
- * supernatural events;
- * heroic adventures.

繁體中文：

* **騎士傳奇**

* **中古傳奇文學**

36. **chivalric romance = 騎士傳奇**

> narratives involving knights, quests, courtly ideals and adventure.

37. **Arthurian romance = 亞瑟王傳奇**

Romances associated with:

- * King Arthur;
- * knights;
- * quests;
- * related legendary cycles.

R. ROMANCE AS A LITERARY MODE

38. **romance = imaginative/adventurous narrative less constrained by ordinary realism**

In literary criticism, **romance** can describe a mode characterized by:

- * idealization;
- * adventure;
- * marvel;
- * extraordinary situations;
- * symbolic rather than strictly realistic storytelling.

This is broader than modern **romance novel = love story**.

S. ROMANCE VS NOVEL — LITERARY THEORY

Historically/literarily:

novel

often associated with everyday/social realism.

romance

often permits:

- * improbable events;
- * idealized characters;
- * symbolic adventures;

* supernatural/marvelous elements.

This distinction is not absolute and varies by literary period.

T. ROMANCE = FANCIFUL TALE

39. **romance = fanciful or improbable story (傳奇故事 ; 幻想故事) — literary/older**

> “The account reads more like romance than history.”

Approximately:

「這個記述與其說是歷史，不如說像一篇**傳奇幻想故事**。」

Lower-frequency modern usage.

U. VERB: ROMANCE SOMEONE

40. **romance someone = court/woo someone romantically (追求 ; 向某人獻殷勤) **

Somewhat old-fashioned/playful.

> “He romanced her with flowers and dinners.”

「他用鮮花和晚餐向她**展開浪漫追求**。」

V. ROMANCE = WOO / COURT

41. **romance = behave toward someone in a consciously romantic way**

May involve:

- * gifts;
- * dinners;
- * affectionate attention;
- * courtship.

The verb is much less common than:

> date

> woo
> court.

W. BUSINESS / PERSUASION: ROMANCE SOMEONE

42. **romance someone = cultivate/flatter/charm them in order to win support or business**

Informal extension of courtship.

> “The sales team spent weeks romancing the client.”

「銷售團隊花了幾星期**拉攏 / 討好客戶**。」

This need not involve romantic love.

The conceptual metaphor is:

> court a lover → court a customer/investor.

43. **romance investors/customers**

Possible business/journalistic use:

> charm and cultivate them to obtain support.

Usually has a slightly humorous or critical tone.

X. ROMANCING = COURTING

44. **romancing = romantic courtship**

> “He spent the evening romancing his date.”

Slightly theatrical/old-fashioned.

45. **romancing a client = 拉攏客戶**

Business figurative branch.

Y. ROMANTIC — LOVE-RELATED

46. **romantic = relating to love/courtship (浪漫愛情的) **

Examples:

- * romantic relationship
- * romantic partner
- * romantic date
- * romantic dinner
- * romantic gesture

Z. ROMANTIC RELATIONSHIP

47. **romantic relationship = 戀愛 / 伴侶關係**

A relationship involving romantic attraction/love, as opposed to:

- * friendship;
- * purely professional relation.

AA. ROMANTIC PARTNER

48. **romantic partner = 戀愛伴侶**

Gender-neutral broad expression.

AB. ROMANTIC INTEREST

49. **romantic interest = romantic attraction toward a person / person who is object of that attraction**

Two common interpretations:

feeling

> “He showed romantic interest in her.”

= 他對她表現出**戀愛興趣**。

person

> “She is his romantic interest in the story.”

= 她是故事中他的**感情對象**。

AC. ROMANTIC ATTRACTION

50. **romantic attraction = 戀愛吸引**

Desire for romantic connection with someone.

AD. ROMANTIC FEELINGS

51. **romantic feelings = 愛慕 / 戀愛感情**

> “I don't have romantic feelings for him.”

「我對他沒有**戀愛感情**。」

AE. ROMANTIC GESTURE

52. **romantic gesture = 浪漫舉動**

Examples:

- * flowers;
- * surprise dinner;
- * affectionate letter.

What counts as romantic is culturally/personal-context dependent.

AF. ROMANTIC DATE / DINNER

53. **romantic date = 浪漫約會**

54. **romantic dinner = 浪漫晚餐**

AG. ROMANTIC = IDEALISTIC / NOT PRACTICAL

A very important second adjective branch.

55. **romantic = idealistic, imaginative, somewhat unrealistic (浪漫主義的 ; 不切實際地理想化的)**

> “He has a romantic view of entrepreneurship.”

「他對創業抱有一種**浪漫化、過分理想的看法**。」

This connects directly to your passage.

56. **romantic notion / idea = 浪漫化的想法**

> “The idea that every café owner spends all day chatting with customers is rather romantic.”

「認為每個咖啡店老闆每天只是跟客人聊天，是相當**浪漫化的想法**。」

57. **romantic view of the past**

= 對過去抱有美化、理想化的看法.

AH. ROMANTIC = EVOCATIVE / PICTURESQUE

58. **romantic = beautiful, mysterious, picturesque, emotionally evocative (浪漫優美的)**

> “They stayed in a romantic old hotel.”

「他們住在一間很有**浪漫情調**的古老酒店。」

59. **romantic landscape = 浪漫壯麗 / 富詩意的景色**

Can mean:

- * visually beautiful;
- * dramatic;
- * evocative.

Not necessarily about couples.

60. **romantic atmosphere = 浪漫氣氛**

Can be:

- * intimate love-related;
- * generally dreamy/beautiful.

Context decides.

AI. ROMANTIC PERSON

61. **a romantic = person who strongly values romance/love (浪漫的人)**

> “He's a romantic at heart.”

「他骨子裏是個**浪漫的人**。」

Countable noun.

AJ. HOPELESS ROMANTIC

62. **hopeless romantic = deeply sentimental believer in romantic love (無可救藥的浪漫主義者)**

Usually affectionate/humorous.

> “She's a hopeless romantic.”

「她是個**無可救藥的浪漫派**。」

It does not usually mean:

> hopeless at relationships.

It means:

> strongly attached to romantic ideals.

AK. OLD ROMANTIC

63. **an old romantic = 老派浪漫的人**

Someone who enjoys traditional romantic gestures/ideas.

AL. ROMANTICALLY

64. **romantically = in a romantic/love-related way (浪漫地 ; 戀愛方面)**

> “They became romantically involved.”

「他們發展成**戀愛關係**。」

65. **romantically involved = 有戀愛關係**

A useful formal/euphemistic expression.

66. **romantically attracted to = 在戀愛上被.....吸引**

AM. ROMANTICALLY = IN AN IDEALIZED WAY

67. **romantically = idealistically / with romantic imagination**

> “The era is often portrayed romantically.”

「那個時代常被**浪漫化地描繪**。」

Less common than:

> romanticized.

AN. ROMANTICIZE / ROMANTICISE

68. **romanticize = describe/view something as more attractive, exciting, noble, or ideal than reality warrants (浪漫化 ; 美化) **

This is a crucial family member for your passage.

> “People often romanticize owning a café.”

「人們常常把經營咖啡店**浪漫化**。」

69. **romanticize the past = 美化過去**

> “We tend to romanticize the past.”

「我們往往會**美化過去**。」

Often implies ignoring:

- * hardship;
- * conflict;
- * inconvenience;
- * negative facts.

70. **romanticize poverty / war / struggle**

= 把艱苦、戰爭、掙扎描繪得過分迷人或高尚.

Usually critical.

71. **romanticize entrepreneurship**

Extremely relevant here:

> focus on freedom, creativity, independence
> while overlooking rent, cash flow, staffing, failure.

AO. ROMANTICIZATION

72. **romanticization = process/result of portraying something in an unrealistically attractive way
(浪漫化 ; 美化) **

> “The article criticizes the romanticization of entrepreneurship.”

「文章批評對創業的**浪漫化描繪**。」

AP. UNROMANTIC

73. **unromantic = lacking romantic feeling/atmosphere (不浪漫的) **

> “It was a very unromantic proposal.”

「那次求婚非常**不浪漫**。」

74. **unromantic = practical, mundane rather than glamorous**

> “Running a café involves many unromantic tasks.”

「經營咖啡店涉及很多**毫不浪漫、非常實際的工作**。」

This fits your passage exceptionally well:

- * washing;
- * stock;
- * rent;
- * payroll;
- * cleaning;
- * licences.

AQ. ROMANTICISM — GENERAL LOWERCASE

75. **romanticism = tendency toward romantic/idealized thinking (浪漫思想 ; 浪漫化傾向) **

Lowercase can refer generally to:

> sentimental or idealized attitudes.

Example:

> “There is too much romanticism in his view of business.”

「他對營商的看法有太多**浪漫化色彩**。」

AR. **ROMANTICISM** — ARTISTIC/INTELLECTUAL MOVEMENT

76. **Romanticism** = historical artistic, literary, musical and intellectual movement (浪漫主義)

Capitalized **Romanticism** refers broadly to the movement especially influential in Europe around the late eighteenth and nineteenth centuries.

Frequently associated with emphasis on things such as:

- * imagination;
- * emotion;
- * nature;
- * individuality;
- * the sublime;
- * reaction against certain forms of rationalism/classicism,

though individual Romantic thinkers/artists differed enormously.

****繁體中文： ** 浪漫主義****

AS. ROMANTIC — HISTORICAL MOVEMENT

77. **Romantic** = belonging to Romanticism (浪漫主義的) ******

Examples:

- * Romantic poetry
- * Romantic music
- * Romantic art
- * Romantic composer

Capitalization helps distinguish this from:

> romantic dinner.

AT. A ROMANTIC — HISTORICAL

78. **a Romantic = writer/artist/thinker associated with Romanticism (浪漫主義者)**

Example:

> “The poet is usually classified as a Romantic.”

「這名詩人通常被歸為**浪漫主義詩人**。」

AU. ROMANTIC MUSIC ≠ ROMANTIC LOVE MUSIC

Critical distinction.

Romantic music

historical/style term relating to the Romantic era/movement.

romantic music

music creating a love-related/intimate mood.

Capitalization/context matters.

AV. ROMANCE — MUSIC

79. **romance = short lyrical musical composition (浪漫曲 ; 抒情曲)**

In classical music, **romance** can refer to a lyrical, expressive instrumental or vocal piece.

繁體中文：

* **浪漫曲**

* **抒情曲**

This has nothing necessarily to do with a love affair.

80. **romance for violin/piano/etc.**

> a lyrical composition titled/described as a romance.

Specialist music terminology.

AW. ROMANCE SCAM / FRAUD

81. **romance scam = fraud in which someone pretends to develop a romantic relationship to obtain money or other benefit (網戀詐騙 / 愛情騙局)**

A major modern compound.

Typical pattern:

> fake intimacy/trust → request for money/information.

82. **romance fraud = 愛情詐騙**

More formal/law-enforcement wording.

83. **romance scammer = 愛情騙徒**

Related compound rather than direct morphological derivative.

AX. **ROMANCE LANGUAGES** — COMPLETELY DIFFERENT BRANCH

Capitalized **Romance** is extremely important.

84. **Romance = relating to languages descended historically from Latin (羅曼語族的)**

Examples include:

* French

- * Spanish
- * Portuguese
- * Italian
- * Romanian

among others.

****繁體中文：****

****羅曼語族****

* sometimes ****拉丁語族**** informally, though ****羅曼語族**** is more precise.

AY. ROMANCE LANGUAGE

85. **a Romance language = a language descended from spoken/vernacular Latin (羅曼語) **

> “Spanish is a Romance language.”

「西班牙語屬於****羅曼語族****。」

This has ****nothing to do with romantic love****.

AZ. ROMANCE LANGUAGES

86. **the Romance languages = 羅曼語族**

A branch of the Indo-European language family descended historically from Latin varieties used across the Roman world.

BA. ROMANCE LINGUISTICS / PHILOLOGY

87. **Romance linguistics = 羅曼語言學**

Study of Romance languages.

88. **Romance philology = 羅曼語文學 / 語言歷史研究**

Historical specialist term for comparative/historical study of Romance languages and texts.

BB. WHY “ROMANCE” MEANS BOTH LANGUAGES AND LOVE STORIES

Historically, the senses are related.

The word developed from terms referring to writing/speaking in the vernacular languages derived from Latin rather than Latin itself.

Stories written in those vernaculars came to be called **“romances”**, especially tales of:

- * knights;
- * adventure;
- * love.

From that literary meaning developed the modern association with:

> love and romantic relationships.

So:

- > **“Romance languages”**
- > → vernacular-language history

and

- > **“romance = love”**

are historically related, though synchronically their meanings are very different.

BC. ROMANCER

89. **“romancer = person who woos/courts romantically — rare/old-fashioned”**

Potential meaning:

- > romantic pursuer.

Low priority.

90. **“romancer = writer/teller of romances — literary/archaic”**

Could historically mean:

> writer or teller of romantic/adventurous tales.

Low priority.

91. **romancer = person who tells fanciful/untrue stories — archaic**

Older usage could imply:

> teller of invented tales.

Very low priority, but genuine historical branch.

BD. "ROMANCE" AS VERB = FANTASIZE / EMBELLISH — OLD/RARE

92. **romance = tell fanciful stories / embellish imaginatively (編造傳奇 ; 誇飾) — archaic/literary**

Historically possible, related to:

> romance as fanciful narrative.

Modern learners generally do not need this as an active-use sense.

BE. IMPORTANT COLLOCATIONS

Love relationship

- * budding romance
- * brief romance
- * whirlwind romance
- * secret romance
- * office romance
- * holiday romance
- * summer romance
- * forbidden romance

General romantic feeling

- * love and romance
- * keep the romance alive
- * add romance
- * lack romance

Idealized appeal

- * the romance of travel
- * the romance of adventure
- * the romance of entrepreneurship
- * strip away the romance
- * romance versus reality

Fiction

- * romance novel
- * romance fiction
- * historical romance
- * contemporary romance
- * paranormal romance

BF. **BUDDING ROMANCE**

93. **budding romance = 戀情萌芽**

A relationship just beginning to become romantic.

BG. **BLOSSOMING ROMANCE**

94. **blossoming romance = 正在發展的戀情**

Figurative plant metaphor:

> relationship is growing.

BH. **REKINDLE THE ROMANCE**

95. **rekindle the romance = 重燃浪漫 / 愛火**

> “They took a holiday to rekindle the romance.”

「他們去度假，希望**重燃感情中的浪漫**。」

BI. **SPARK A ROMANCE**

96. **spark a romance = 引發 / 開始一段戀情**

> “The project sparked a romance between them.”

「這個項目促成了兩人的**戀情**。」

BJ. **ROMANCE BLOSSOMS / DEVELOPS**

97. **a romance blossoms/develops = 戀情逐漸發展**

Literary/journalistic.

BK. ROMANTICIZE VS IDEALIZE

romanticize

portray something as more attractive, beautiful, exciting, noble, or emotionally appealing than reality.

idealize

represent something as perfect or better than it really is.

They overlap strongly.

Romanticize often adds:

> emotional glamour / beauty / nostalgia.

BL. ROMANTICIZE VS GLAMORIZE

glamorize

make something appear glamorous/exciting/attractive.

romanticize

make it emotionally/poetically idealized.

Example:

- > romanticize café ownership
- > glamorize celebrity life.

Large overlap.

BM. ROMANCE VS LOVE

love

very broad emotional attachment.

Can be:

- * romantic;
- * familial;
- * friendship;
- * affection for activities/things.

romance

specifically:

- * romantic love/courtship;
- * romantic relationship;
- * romantic atmosphere.

You can love your parents, but that is not **romance**.

BN. ROMANCE VS RELATIONSHIP

relationship

any connection between people/entities.

romance

specifically romantic relationship or romantic element.

- > workplace relationship
- > could be professional.

- > workplace romance
- > is romantic.

BO. ROMANCE VS AFFAIR

romance

neutral/positive romantic relationship.

affair

can mean a romantic/sexual relationship, often especially one that is secret or involves infidelity.

Do not automatically translate every **romance** as **婚外情**.

BP. ROMANCE VS COURTSHIP

courtship

process of pursuing/developing a serious romantic relationship.

romance

can mean:

- * relationship itself;
- * romantic feeling;
- * idealized love.

BQ. ROMANCE VS DATING

dating

activity/status of going on dates.

romance

emotional/romantic relationship or atmosphere.

Someone can be dating casually without describing it as:

> a romance.

BR. ROMANCE VS PASSION

passion

intense emotion/desire.

romance

romantic attachment or idealized atmosphere.

A romance may contain passion, but they are not synonymous.

BS. ROMANCE VS SEX

romance

emphasizes romantic/emotional connection.

sex

sexual activity/sexual dimension.

They may coexist but neither necessarily implies the other.

BT. ROMANCE VS FLIRTATION

flirtation

playful behavior showing possible attraction, often without serious relationship.

romance

usually more developed romantic involvement.

BU. ROMANTIC VS SENTIMENTAL

romantic

related to love, idealization, beauty, imagination.

sentimental

strongly emotional/tender, sometimes excessively so.

A sentimental object need not be romantic.

BV. ROMANTIC VS DREAMY

You mapped **dream** already.

romantic atmosphere

emotionally beautiful/intimate or picturesque.

dreamy atmosphere

soft, hazy, unreal, ethereal.

They often overlap but emphasize different qualities.

BW. ROMANTIC VS PRACTICAL

This is central to your passage.

romantic

focused on idealized/emotional appeal.

practical

focused on what actually works and can be achieved.

The essay says café ownership must be approached:

> practically rather than romantically.

BX. ROMANTIC VS REALISTIC

romantic view

may beautify or idealize reality.

realistic view

takes limitations, costs, probabilities and difficulties seriously.

Again, this is the passage's exact contrast.

BY. ROMANTIC VS ROMANCE — POS

romance

noun:

- > a romance
- > the romance of travel.

Verb:

- > romance someone.

romantic

adjective:

- > romantic dinner
- > romantic idea.

Noun:

- > a hopeless romantic.

BZ. ROMANCE VS ROMANTICISM

romance

love relationship / idealized charm / literary narrative.

romanticism

general tendency toward romantic idealization.

Romanticism

specific historical cultural movement.

Do not merge these blindly.

CA. CAPITALIZATION TRAPS

romantic

> a romantic dinner

love/atmosphere.

Romantic

> a Romantic poet

historical movement.

romance

> a holiday romance

love relationship.

Romance

> a Romance language

language-family term.

Capitalization can completely change the domain.

CB. GRAMMAR

98. **a romance with someone**

> “She had a romance with a colleague.”

99. **a romance between A and B**

> “a romance between the two characters”

100. **the romance of + noun**

> the romance of travel

> the romance of café ownership.

This is the exact conceptual pattern behind your passage.

101. **romance + direct object — verb**

> romance someone

> romance a client

No preposition required.

102. **romantically involved with**

> “She is romantically involved with him.”

Formal/euphemistic.

103. **romantic feelings for someone**

> “He has romantic feelings for her.”

104. **romanticize + object**

> romanticize the past

> romanticize entrepreneurship

> romanticize poverty.

CC. COUNTABILITY

romance = relationship

Countable:

> a romance

> several romances.

romance = story/genre work

Countable:

> a medieval romance

> three romances.

romance = general romantic feeling

Usually uncountable:

> add some romance

> there is little romance left.

romance = glamour/idealized quality

Usually uncountable:

> the romance of travel.

Romance = language classification

Usually attributive:

> Romance language

> Romance linguistics.

Plural noun phrase:

> the Romance languages.

CD. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning	
-----	-----	
romance — relationship	romantic love relationship	
romance — romantic feeling	love/courtship/affectionate excitement generally	
romance — idealized appeal	glamour, beauty or emotional fantasy surrounding something	
romance — modern fiction	story/genre centered on romantic relationship	
romance — medieval literature	adventure/chivalric legendary narrative	
romance — literary mode	idealized, adventurous, marvelous narrative rather than strict realism	
romance — music	lyrical musical composition	
romance — verb	court/woo someone	
romance — business verb	charm/cultivate someone to gain support	
romantic — love	related to romantic love	
romantic — idealized	imaginative/idealistic, sometimes unrealistic	
romantic — picturesque	emotionally beautiful or evocative	
a romantic	person devoted to romantic ideals	
Romantic	connected with historical Romanticism	
Romanticism	historical artistic/intellectual movement	
romanticize	make something seem more attractive/ideal than reality	
romanticization	act/process of romanticizing	
unromantic	lacking romance/glamour; mundane	
Romance	relating to languages descended from Latin	
romancer	wooer/storyteller; rare/older	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
romance — love relationship	一段帶有愛情 / 戀愛性質的關係；戀情
have a romance with X	與 X 發展一段戀情
whirlwind romance	發展非常快速而強烈的戀情
summer/holiday romance	夏日 / 旅行期間發展的短期戀情
office romance	同一工作場所人士之間的戀情
secret/forbidden romance	秘密 / 受到社會或其他限制的戀情
romance — general love	戀愛中的浪漫感、愛情氣氛
keep the romance alive	維持伴侶關係中的浪漫感
the romance of X	X 所帶來的理想化、迷人、富想像力的魅力
romance — unrealistic idealization	把某生活方式看得過分美好的一種浪漫幻想
romance novel / fiction	以浪漫愛情關係為主要故事核心的小說 / 文類
historical romance	以歷史時代為背景的爱情小說
romantic comedy	以愛情發展配合喜劇元素的愛情喜劇
medieval/chivalric romance	以騎士、冒險、傳奇、宮廷愛情等為特色的中古傳奇
romance — literary mode	偏重傳奇、奇遇、理想化或超常情節的文學敘事模式
romance — music	抒情、旋律性的古典音樂小品；浪漫曲
romance someone — verb	以浪漫方式追求 / 向某人獻殷勤
romance a client/investor	比喻用魅力、討好和關係經營拉攏客戶 / 投資者
romantic relationship	戀愛關係
romantic partner	戀愛伴侶
romantic interest	戀愛興趣；也可指感情對象
romantic attraction	戀愛層面的吸引
romantic gesture	表達愛意 / 浪漫情感的舉動
romantic — idealistic	對某事抱有美好但不切實際的理想化想法
romantic — picturesque	優美、富情調、令人產生浪漫聯想的
a romantic	重視浪漫愛情和理想的人
hopeless romantic	非常相信 / 迷戀浪漫愛情觀念的人
romantically involved	正處於戀愛關係中
romanticize	把事物描寫 / 想像得比現實更美好、更迷人
romanticize the past	美化過去，忽略當中的困難 / 負面部分
romanticization	把事物理想化、浪漫化的過程
unromantic	缺乏浪漫感；亦可指非常實際、單調、不迷人的
romanticism — lowercase	浪漫化、理想化事物的思想傾向
Romanticism	十八世紀末至十九世紀特別重要的歷史浪漫主義文化運動
Romantic poet/music/art	屬於歷史浪漫主義運動 / 時期的詩歌、音樂、藝術
Romance language	從拉丁語歷史發展而來的羅曼語族語言
Romance languages	法語、西班牙語、意大利語等所屬的羅曼語族
Romance linguistics	研究羅曼語族的語言學
romance scam/fraud	假裝建立愛情關係以騙取金錢 / 利益的愛情詐騙

| **romancer — old/rare** | 追求者、傳奇故事作者 / 講述者，或舊式幻想故事者
|

For your original passage

> “First, a café is a business before it is a **romance**.”

The most precise interpretation is:

> **romance = the seductive, idealized lifestyle image of owning a café.**

The next sentence deliberately supplies the **romance**:

- * warm lighting
- * handwritten menu
- * fresh pastries

and then destroys the illusion with the **business reality**:

- * rent
- * renovation
- * wages
- * food waste
- * licensing
- * suppliers
- * empty Tuesdays.

So a strong Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **「首先，咖啡店歸根究柢是一門生意，而不是一場浪漫幻想。」**

This also connects tightly to **romanticize**:

> Kam Chai must not **romanticize café ownership**.

That would mean:

> **只看咖啡店自由、漂亮、有情調的一面，而忽略成本、營運和倒閉風險。**

For your core database, I would keep **7 principal semantic branches**:

1. **romantic love relationship**
2. **romantic feeling/courtship generally**
3. **idealized glamour, adventure or emotional appeal — the passage sense**
4. **modern love-centered fiction/entertainment**
5. **medieval/adventurous literary romance**

6. **verb: woo/court, plus figurative business cultivation**

7. **specialized capitalized Romance = Latin-descended language family**

Then separately index **romantic, Romantic, Romanticism, romanticize, romanticization, unromantic, romance scam, romance in music**, because each has an established meaning that would be lost if the whole family were reduced simply to 「浪漫 / 愛情」.